CAPABILITY STATEMENT

Major Projects and Construction

Client insight. Aligned teams. Stronger project outcomes.

We help contractors and project partners understand what matters to their client, shape a credible strategy and carry that promise through procurement and delivery.



Prepared for UGL | October 2026

A PERSONAL NOTE

Thank you for the opportunity to share our story with UGL.

Dear Matthew,

Thank you for your interest in The Strategy Group, and for the opportunity to share a little more about who we are and how we work.

Over the past five years, we have had the privilege of working alongside UGL/CPB on some of the most significant infrastructure pursuits in New South Wales. From Sydney Metro West Linewide 2, where we were embedded with the team during the tender period, to the Hunter Transmission Project and New England REZ, we have seen first-hand what your teams are capable of when they put the client at the centre of every conversation.

What has stayed with me most is not the bids themselves, but the people. We have watched engineers and project leaders who are deeply expert in their fields grow into confident, empathetic communicators who can sit across the table from an evaluation panel and show, not just tell, that they understand what the client needs. That shift has taken place through trust, honest feedback and a willingness to do things differently, and the UGL & CPB teams that we've worked with have shown all three.

In this statement, we set out how we support major project teams and share the engagements we have been part of with UGL/CPB, so you can see our work through the lens of your own pursuits.

I would welcome the opportunity to meet with you, introduce you to some of our team and hear more about what lies ahead for UGL. We see this as the start of a conversation, and a partnership we would be delighted to build on.

Warm regards,



Jeffrey Tobias

Managing Director, The Strategy Group

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Acknowledgement of Country

The Strategy Group acknowledges the Gadigal people of the Eora Nation as the Traditional Custodians of the land on which we work. We also recognise and respect the Traditional Owners and Custodians of Country across Australia, honouring their enduring connection to land, waters and community. We pay our respects to their cultures and to Elders past, present and emerging.

The Strategy Group is committed to fostering a culture of inclusivity, respect and belonging for all.

OUR PROPOSITION

We help major project teams understand what the client values, unite around one clear proposition and prove it in every interaction that counts.

Major projects bring together sponsors, procurement teams, operators, communities, delivery partners and technical disciplines. Each sees risk and value from a different position. A technically sound proposal will have greater impact when the team can show it understands those perspectives, can make difficult decisions together and can deliver what it promises.

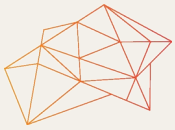
We work alongside contractors, joint ventures and project leaders to uncover client priorities, turn those insights into a clear strategic position, align the people who must deliver it and prepare for the moments when the client judges the team, whether online or in person. Our role can begin before a formal procurement and continue after award as relationships and requirements evolve.

2003
Consulting to the public and private sectors since

600+
Projects delivered across multiple industries

120%
Growth over the last 3 years

The difference we aim to make



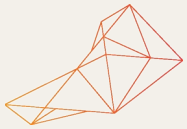
A proposition grounded in the client's outcomes and the project's realities.



One coherent team across partners, disciplines and client facing interactions.



Workshops and presentations that progress decisions and build trust.



A practical link between the bid promise and the experience of delivery.



OUR OFFER

Where we add value

We shape our involvement to the project and procurement pathway. Our three areas of support connect with each other and with your technical team. They are not a fixed sequence, and they do not replace the technical bid.

01
Strategic Advisory
End-to-end bid strategy

- Win strategy and competitive positioning
- Client and stakeholder intelligence
- Messaging and narrative development
- Advisory across the full bid life cycle

02
Team Alignment and Culture
JV or single team alignment

- Cross partner and cross national integration
- One shared identity, purpose and language
- Customer centricity coaching
- Ongoing cultural alignment sessions

03
Interactive Preparation
Preparation and delivery

- Proven 8-step interactive process
- Presentation and delivery coaching
- Rehearsal, live support and debrief
- Readiness for every client facing moment

We also provide strategic research and facilitation where a project needs a focused intervention outside a full bid or delivery engagement.

OUR OFFER

Support at the moments that matter

Clients form a view of a team long before the contract is signed and keep testing it long after. We focus our support on the points in the project life cycle where that view is shaped.

01 Early Positioning

THE CLIENT IS ASKING

What does the contractor need to achieve and how will it add value?

HOW WE HELP

- Client and stakeholder research
- Opportunity strategy
- Positioning and relationship planning

WHAT YOU GET

A tested understanding of priorities and a clear basis for pursuit decisions.

02 ECI and Bid Development

THE CLIENT IS ASKING

Can the team challenge requirements constructively and demonstrate a credible approach?

HOW WE HELP

- Win strategy
- Narrative development
- Cross partner alignment
- Workshop design

WHAT YOU GET

A coherent proposition and evidence that connects innovation to client outcomes.

03 Evaluation Interactions

THE CLIENT IS ASKING

Does this feel like one team who we can work with under pressure?

HOW WE HELP

- Interactive and presentation preparation
- Coaching and rehearsal
- Facilitation support
- Debrief

WHAT YOU GET

Purposeful sessions, confident presenters and actions carried into the next stage.

04 Award and Delivery

THE CLIENT IS ASKING

Will the team fulfil the relationship and behaviours promised in the bid?

HOW WE HELP

- Leadership alignment
- Client engagement routines
- Milestone preparation
- Feedback sessions

WHAT YOU GET

A stronger client relationship and early visibility of friction or changing priorities.

Our role can begin before a formal procurement and continue after award as relationships and requirements evolve.



HOW WE WORK

Insight becomes action

Our human centred approach turns what we learn into decisions, behaviours and moments the client can see for themselves.

01 Listen and Diagnose

Review the available project evidence, hear from leaders and specialists, and understand the client's objectives, constraints and decision context.

02 Co-create and Pressure Test

Bring the right people together to surface assumptions, resolve tensions and agree a proposition and behaviours the team can stand behind.

03 Prepare and Demonstrate

Translate the strategy into messages, interactions, speaker preparation and practical ways of working that the client can experience.

04 Learn and Adapt

Debrief consequential interactions, capture decisions and feedback, and adjust the approach as procurement or delivery evolves.

How we engage

Focused advisory

Targeted support for a single decision or interaction, such as a pursuit decision, a key workshop or an evaluation presentation.

Embedded support

We join the bid and delivery team over a longer program, from early positioning through to award and into delivery.

Scope, roles and outputs are agreed against the client's needs, the procurement rules and the team's existing capability.

OUR VALUES IN THE ROOM

What working with us feels like

Our values shape how we show up alongside your team, from the first workshop to the final presentation.

Ambition



We aim for the win, and for a delivery phase that lives up to it. We push for a proposition that stands apart, not one that simply complies.

Authenticity



We tell you what we hear, including the hard things. The promises we help you make are ones your team can keep.

Creativity



We design workshops, interactions and narratives that help evaluators see your thinking in action, not only read about it.

Empathy



We start with the client's world: their pressures, their stakeholders and what success looks like to them. Then we help your team show it understands.

OUR PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Our work with CPB Contractors and UGL

We have partnered with CPB Contractors and UGL across rail, tunnelling, transmission and renewable energy pursuits. Each engagement has built on the last, deepening our understanding of how your teams work and what your clients expect.

Engagement	Our role and outcome
Sydney Metro West Linewide 2 CPB Contractors and UGL JV | Sydney Metro	Strategy workshop, unique selling proposition, customer-centric training and coaching, and preparation and debriefs for every client interactive.
Hunter Transmission Project CPB Contractors and UGL JV | Transgrid	Engagement strategy, rehearsal and debriefs across five client interactives. The JV progressed from a field of four to the final two.
Eastern Tunnelling Package John Holland, CPB Contractors and Ghella JV | Sydney Metro West	Embedded support for more than five years, from tender strategy and client interactives through award and into delivery. The JV won the $1.6bn contract.
New England REZ CPB Contractors and UGL	Focused preparation, rehearsal and debrief for a critical client interactive.
Customer-centric skills program CPB Contractors and UGL JV	Four practical workshops building the skills, behaviours and confidence to engage clients and win competitive bids.
Parramatta Light Rail Stage 2 CPB Contractors	Selected as the bid strategy partner. CPB was not shortlisted.
Submarine infrastructure program Australian Naval Infrastructure	Selected as the engagement partner. Package 3 has since been deferred.
GoFar CPB Contractors, Vinci Grand Projets and Ferrovial	Current engagement.

The profiles that follow show how each engagement unfolded: the client challenge, our role and what changed as a result.

OUR PROJECT EXPERIENCE

BID STRATEGY | TEAM ALIGNMENT | INTERACTIVE PREPARATION

Transforming how a JV engages with its client

CPB Contractors and UGL JV | Sydney Metro West Linewide 2



The client challenge

Sydney Metro had raised its expectations of delivery contractors, asking for open collaboration within an increasingly rigid, risk-averse contractual environment. The JV knew a strong technical submission would not be enough. It needed a fundamentally different way of engaging its client.

Our role

We ran a strategy workshop that united the JV around a shared purpose, a clear picture of what Sydney Metro needed and a co-created unique selling proposition. Bespoke training and coaching followed. We prepared the team for each technical interactive, debriefed every touchpoint and reviewed the written submission.

What changed

A team that had previously led with technical expertise emerged with a shared strategy, a clear purpose and the skills to engage Sydney Metro with empathy and intention. Debriefs sharpened its approach, coaching lifted its presence and the submission told the same coherent story.

> The result was a bid team that presented as genuinely cohesive and client-focused, reflecting exactly what Sydney Metro had signalled it was looking for.

OUR PROJECT EXPERIENCE

EVALUATION INTERACTIONS | INTERACTIVE PREPARATION

Building a team that performs when it matters most

CPB Contractors and UGL JV | Hunter Transmission Project



The client challenge

Transgrid had heightened expectations of its delivery partners, and several capable tenderers were in the field. The JV recognised that technical credentials alone would not decide the outcome. It needed consistent, empathetic engagement aligned to what Transgrid needed to see and hear.

Our role

We worked with the bid team from the outset to set a clear engagement strategy aligned to Transgrid's priorities. Before each interactive, we ran structured preparation and rehearsal sessions to sharpen the narrative and presentation skills. After each one, we debriefed what worked and what needed to shift.

What changed

Across five client interactives, the team's messaging became sharper, its presence stronger and its approach more consistent, reflecting genuine cultural change within the bid team. Of the four original tenderers, the JV progressed to the final two.

> A repeatable cycle of develop, finalise, rehearse and present gave the team the best possible chance of delighting the client at every interactive.

OUR PROJECT EXPERIENCE

ECI AND BID DEVELOPMENT | EVALUATION INTERACTIONS

Embedding customer centricity to win the Eastern Tunnelling Package

John Holland, CPB Contractors and Ghella JV | Sydney Metro West, Eastern Tunnelling Package



The client challenge

After missing out on a recent Sydney Metro tender, the three JV partners wanted to change how they bid. They needed a more client and user centric approach to compete for the Eastern Tunnelling Package.

Our role

We embedded five customer-centric principles in the tender team through outside-in strategy workshops with 25 JV members, design thinking, knowledge transfer sessions with the client and collaborative problem solving. We trained the team for client meetings, coached them through document review and built an interactive Miro board for client engagement.

What changed

The JV won the $1.6bn contract to dig the final tunnel section of Sydney Metro West. Sydney Metro said it was delighted by the JV through the tender, and cited the collaboration between the teams as a critical factor in the award. Our engagement continued for more than five years.

> *"Thank you again for the tremendous support along the tender ... your guidance undoubtedly played a big part in helping us convey our real value."*
>
> Scott Connor, Construction Director, CPB Contractors

OUR PROJECT EXPERIENCE

More of our work with CPB and UGL

Alongside full bid engagements, we provide focused support for shorter, high-stakes interactions and build lasting capability within the team.

EVALUATION INTERACTIONS | FOCUSED ADVISORY

Preparing for a critical client interactive

CPB Contractors and UGL | New England Renewable Energy Zone

Building on our work together on the Hunter Transmission Project, the CPB and UGL team engaged us to support a high-stakes client interactive for New England REZ. We applied the same proven cycle: aligning the team on what the client needed to hear, shaping a clear and consistent narrative, and developing the right messaging for the interactive. The team presented with focus and confidence, showing its understanding of the client.

1
Critical client interactive, supported from preparation to debrief

4 steps
Develop, finalise, rehearse and present

TEAM ALIGNMENT AND CULTURE | CAPABILITY BUILDING

Developing customer-centric skills to win competitive bids

CPB Contractors and UGL JV | Bespoke training program

The JV's technical expertise was well regarded, but its teams wanted the skills, behaviours and tools to connect more deeply with client needs. We designed and delivered a bespoke program covering active listening, an entrepreneurial mindset, executive presence, managing pressure, persuasion, storytelling, presentation design and key messaging, reinforced through role plays, team challenges and follow-up resources. The team came away more confident, better able to tailor its communication to each client, and with customer centricity embedded in its bid process.

4
In-person practical workshops

9
Customer-centric skill areas, from active listening to storytelling

ABOUT THE STRATEGY GROUP

Who we are

We exist to transform human experiences.

Founded in 2003, The Strategy Group is a Sydney based strategy and experience consultancy. We combine research, human centred design, facilitation and practical implementation support. We work across construction, government and other sectors, bringing an outside-in perspective to the people and organisational challenges that shape outcomes.

Your project team



Jeffrey Tobias
Managing Director



Heather King
Manager, Major Projects & Construction



Alycia Wolf
Senior Strategist

Broader capabilities for your organisation

A major project can expose wider opportunities across the business. Where relevant, clients can draw on these established TSG services.

Customer Experience

Research client, user and community needs, map journeys and service handovers, improve touchpoints and measure satisfaction.

Employee Experience

Understand workforce needs and improve the experience of onboarding, engagement and working across teams.

Innovation Strategy

Explore opportunities, test ideas with stakeholders and shape a practical path from insight to implementation.

AI Strategy

Assess use cases, select tools, build skills and design responsible workflows for service delivery and productivity.

EVERY EXPERIENCE IS STRATEGY IN ACTION

Let’s discuss your next pursuit

We would welcome the chance to meet with you, introduce you to our team and explore how we can support UGL’s upcoming pursuits, from early positioning through to the interactives that matter most.

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contact@thestrategygroup.com.au

